



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*tadā muktiryadā cittam na vāñchati na śocati |
na muñcati na grhṇāti na hr̥syati na kupyati || 8 | 2 | |
tadā bandho yadā cittam saktam kāsvapi dr̥ṣṭiṣu |
tadā mokṣo yadā cittamasaktam sarvadr̥ṣṭiṣu || 8 | 3 | |*

— Aṣṭāvakraḡītā, Prakaraṇa 8 (Chapter 8), Verses 2-3

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Liberation, according to Ashtavakra, dawns when your mind ceases to crave, to lament, to reject, to grasp, to exult, or to become angry. This verse paints a picture of a mind utterly still, unperturbed by the constant push and pull of desire and aversion. It's a state of being where you are no longer a puppet dancing to the strings of your emotions. The key here isn't repression, but rather a transcendence of the very impulses that usually dictate your experience. Imagine a lake, its surface undisturbed, perfectly reflecting the sky. This is the clarity of a mind free from the turbulence of its own making.

Conversely, bondage arises when your mind becomes attached to specific viewpoints, to limited perspectives. It's when you become identified with your opinions, your beliefs, your desires, and your fears. You build walls around yourself, limiting your perception of reality to what confirms your existing biases. However, liberation blooms when your mind is unattached to all viewpoints. This doesn't mean you become devoid of opinions or preferences, but rather that you hold them lightly, recognizing their impermanent and subjective nature. You see beyond the confines of your own mental constructs, embracing the vastness and complexity of existence.

In modern life, this wisdom is profoundly relevant. We are constantly bombarded with information, opinions, and expectations, all vying for our attention and allegiance. Social media, in particular, can exacerbate our tendency to become attached to specific viewpoints, creating echo chambers where we are only exposed to ideas that reinforce our own. To cultivate liberation, you must actively cultivate detachment. Question your assumptions, explore different perspectives, and be willing to let go of your rigid beliefs. Practice mindfulness, observing your thoughts and emotions without judgment, recognizing them as temporary phenomena rather than fixed identities. It's a journey of constant self-inquiry, a gradual unveiling of the truth that lies beyond the limitations of your own mind.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Can you identify one belief or viewpoint that you are particularly attached to, and are you willing to consider that there might be other valid perspectives?